User Manual

Silk Route Manual Booking System

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Technology	React, MySQL, Node.js / Express
Audience	All System Users, Operations & Finance Staff

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1. Welcome

The **Silk Route Manual Booking System** is the centralized web application designed for airport operations, lounge receptionists, and finance staff to manage Commercial Important Person (CIP) and Silk Route Lounge reservations, passenger logs, payment verifications, corporate credit facilities, and daily sales shifts.

This manual explains how to sign in, navigate, and utilize each operational module in the system. It is written for daily operations personnel — no programming or technical background is required.

1.1 Who this manual is for

This manual is intended for:

- **Lounge Reception & Operational Officers:** Staff creating passenger bookings, validating arrivals/departures, and managing passenger services.
- **Finance & Revenue Officers:** Staff monitoring corporate credit accounts, reviewing billing statements, and recording invoice settlement payments.
- **Duty Supervisors & Administrators:** Staff monitoring overall shift income, managing system accounts, and resolving reservation exceptions.

1.2 What you can do in the portal

- **Real-time Lounge Monitoring:** View expected arrivals, departures, pending actions, and confirmed counts directly from the Dashboard.
- **Passenger Reservation Entry:** Register individual and group lounge bookings, passenger passport numbers, flight numbers, and package selections.
- **Automated PDF Receipts:** Automatically generate and email detailed PDF receipts directly to the lead passenger and duty CC contacts.
- **Corporate Credit (On-Credit) Management:** Verify authorized credit company limits, outstanding balances, and guarantee expiries before issuing bookings.
- **Shift & Sales Reconciliation:** Summarize cash, card, and credit collections at the conclusion of each duty shift.
- **Operational Reporting:** Export visitor lists, flight manifests, and immigration/emigration summaries to Microsoft Excel or printable views.

1.3 What the portal does not do

To ensure clear operational boundaries, the Silk Route Manual Booking System:

- Does not directly control airport boarding gate doors or physical security turnstiles.
- Does not process credit card transactions directly via an integrated payment gateway (cash, card slips, and vouchers are validated manually by duty staff).
- Does not alter airline flight schedules automatically — flight details are entered or verified against active flight timetables by duty officers.

Operational Tip

Always ensure that lead passenger contact email addresses are recorded accurately, as the system triggers automated digital PDF confirmation receipts immediately upon reservation submission.

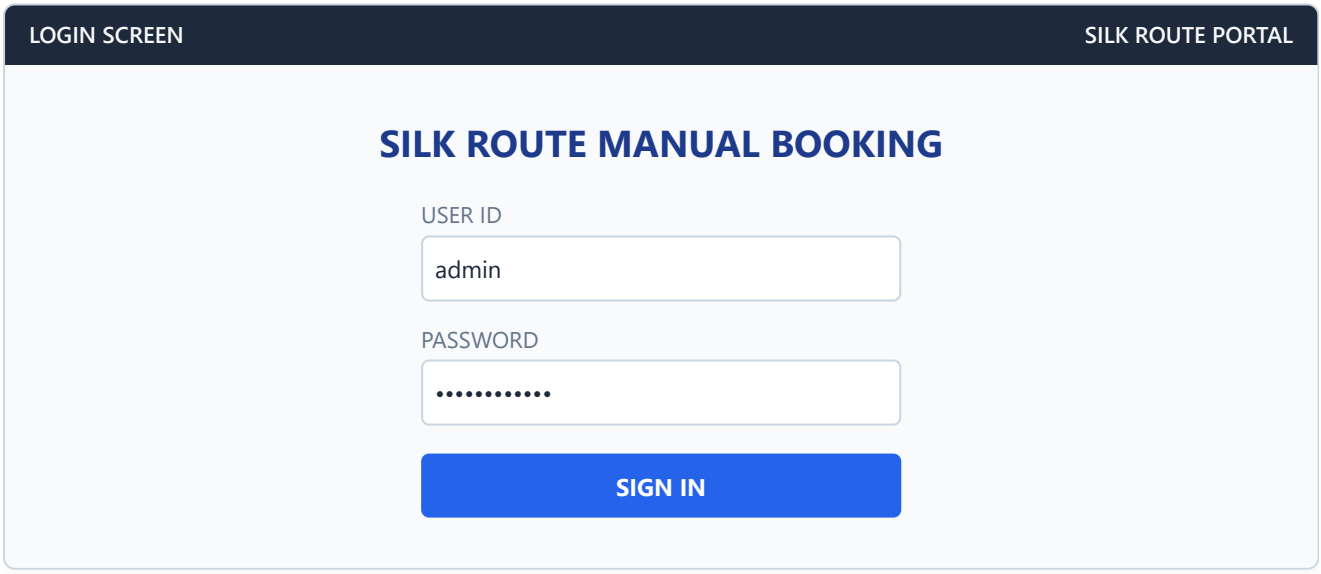
2. Getting Started

2.1 What you need

- A desktop computer, laptop, or terminal running an up-to-date web browser (Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, or Safari).
- Network connectivity to the airport local intranet or application server.
- Your assigned **User ID** and **Password** provided by the System Administrator.
- Access to the backend API service running at `http://localhost:4000/api` and web portal at `http://localhost:3000`.

2.2 Signing in

1. Open your browser and navigate to the application URL: `http://localhost:3000`.
2. On the login page, enter your registered **User ID** in the User ID field.
3. Enter your secret password in the **Password** field.
4. Click the **Sign In / Login** button.



2.3 If sign-in fails

- **Check spelling and casing:** Ensure Caps Lock is disabled and the User ID has no leading or trailing spaces.
- **Inactive account:** If your account has been temporarily disabled or suspended, a prompt will instruct you to contact the administrator.
- **Backend connection check:** If an error indicates "Server not reachable", verify that the backend Node.js service is active on port 4000.

2.4 Signing out

To ensure data security and prevent unauthorized bookings on shared duty desks, always log out when leaving the terminal:

1. Click the **Logout** button located on the top-right header or bottom of the left sidebar.
2. Your session credentials will be cleared immediately from local storage, returning the browser to the secure Login screen.

> **Shift Session Retention**
>
> Upon signing in as an operational user, the system links your actions to the current active operational shift. Ending your duty shift must be formally completed via the **Sales End** module.

3. User Roles and Access Levels

The system enforces role-based access control (RBAC) to maintain security, separation of duties, and financial integrity. Each account is assigned one of three operational roles:

Role	Responsibilities & Scope	Accessible Modules
Administrator	Full system management, user provisioning, role assignments, system-wide reservation modifications, corporate company onboarding, and exception handling.	All modules (User Management, Reservations, Credit, Reports, Sales, Settings).
Standard User *(Operations Staff)*	Day-to-day reservation handling, package bookings, passenger check-ins, searching flight schedules, and executing personal duty sales-shift end summaries.	Dashboard, Package Reservation, Confirmed, Pending, Reports, Search, Sales End.
Finance User	Financial monitoring, auditing credit account balances, reviewing payment proofs, applying corporate bank payments, and extending guarantee expiry limits.	Dashboard, On-Credit Management, Add Payment, Corporate Overviews, Payment Logs.

3.1 Administrator privileges

- Creating, updating, and deactivating user credentials via **Create / Edit User**.
- Authorizing and setting up new credit organizations via **Create Credit Company**.
- Ability to delete pending or confirmed bookings where permitted by operational policy.

3.2 Standard User (Operations) responsibilities

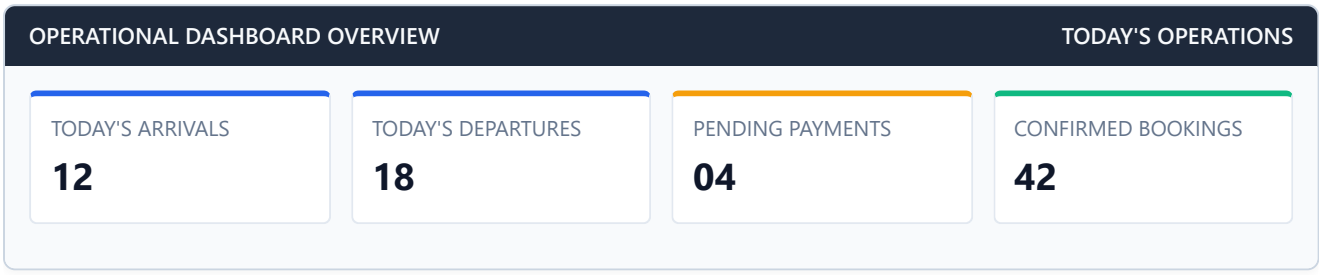
- Ensuring complete and accurate passenger details (Full Names, Passports, Flight Numbers).
- Selecting correct payment types (Cash, Credit Card, On-Credit).
- Completing shift handovers using **Sales End** at the end of each work cycle.

3.3 Finance User responsibilities

- Auditing utilized credit versus authorized limits.
- Posting corporate settlements to reduce outstanding balances using **Finance Add Payment**.
- Preventing unauthorized on-credit bookings when company bank guarantees expire.

4. Your Dashboard

The Dashboard serves as the operational command center upon successful authentication. It provides real-time counts, quick-action navigation, and recent reservation activity.



4.1 Metric summary cards

- **Today's Arrivals:** Total flights and passengers scheduled to arrive and access the Silk Route Lounge today.
- **Today's Departures:** Outbound travelers scheduled for departure lounge hospitality.
- **Pending Payments:** Bookings created without finalized payment vouchers, awaiting verification.
- **Confirmed Bookings:** All active, confirmed, and paid lounge reservations.

4.2 Navigation sidebar

The persistent left sidebar allows instant navigation across all modules:

- **Dashboard:** Returns to the primary operational statistics.
- **Booking Packages:** View available lounge packages and start a standard booking.
- **On-Credit Reservation:** Initiate corporate credit reservation workflows.
- **Reservation Confirmed:** Review all confirmed reservations in the database.
- **Pending Payments:** Review reservations requiring financial clearance.
- **Search & Reports:** Access flight manifests, immigration lists, and visitor records.
- **Sales End:** Finalize shift revenues and generate settlement summaries.

4.3 Recent reservations table

Displays the five most recently created reservations, including Reference Number, Lead Passenger, Flight No, Passenger Count, and Status badge. Clicking a record opens its detailed view.

4.4 Recent activity feed

Located on the right of the dashboard, this audit stream records system actions (e.g., "User admin created booking #SR-1042", "Finance posted payment LKR 50,000 for Dialog").

5. Reservation Operations

5.1 Creating a new package reservation

1. From the navigation menu, select **Booking Packages** or **Package Reservation**.
2. Select the desired package tier (e.g., *Silk Route Premium Arrival* or *Departure Lounge Access*).
3. Enter the **Flight Information**:
   - Flight Number (e.g., `UL-504` or `EK-652`).
   - Flight Date and scheduled Time.
   - Direction: *Arrival* or *Departure*.
4. Enter **Passenger Details**:
   - Title (Mr, Mrs, Hon, Dr, etc.).
   - Full Passenger Name (as indicated on passport).
   - Passport Number.
   - For multiple passengers, click **+ Add Passenger** to attach additional travelers to the reservation.
5. Enter **Lead Contact Details**:
   - Contact Phone Number and Email Address (essential for automated PDF receipts).
6. Select **Payment Details**:
   - Currency: Select `LKR`, `USD`, etc.
   - Payment Method: Select *Cash*, *Card*, or *Bank Voucher*.
7. Click **Submit & Confirm Reservation**.

> **Validation Tip**
> Every booking requires at least one primary passenger with a valid name and passport number. If passport details are missing, the system will highlight the required field and prevent submission.

5.2 Booking confirmation & automated PDF receipts

Once submitted:

1. The reservation record is committed to the database and a unique booking reference number is generated.
2. A confirmation dialog appears with complete reservation particulars.
3. The backend background mailer constructs an official **Silk Route Booking Receipt PDF**.
4. The PDF is dispatched to the lead passenger's email address, with a copy routed to the duty supervisor CC inbox (`BOOKING_EMAIL_CC`).

5.3 Confirmed reservations

To view or export all confirmed bookings:

1. Navigate to **Reservation Confirmed** from the sidebar.
2. A tabular list displays Reference ID, Passenger Names, Flight Number, Date/Time, and Total Amount.
3. Use the search filter at the top to quickly filter records by passenger name or flight.

5.4 Pending payments & review

Reservations awaiting payment verification or credit authorization are stored under **Pending Payments**:

1. Navigate to **Pending Payments**.
2. Select a pending booking to review passenger and payment status.
3. Once payment has been received or verified, click **Mark as Confirmed** to transition the record to confirmed status.

5.5 Editing reservations

Operational requirements often require modifying flight times, correcting passport numbers, or adding additional passengers:

1. Navigate to **Edit Confirmed** or **Edit Pending Reservations**.
2. Locate the target reservation and select **Edit**.
3. Update passenger records, flight numbers, or contact information.
4. Click **Save Changes**. The system verifies that the booking status is still active before applying modifications.

5.6 Deleting and cancelling reservations

Authorized supervisors and administrators can remove erroneous or cancelled reservations:

1. Navigate to **Delete Confirm Reservation** or **Delete Pending Reservations**.
2. Select the reservation to be cancelled.
3. Provide a mandatory cancellation remark/reason.
4. Confirm the deletion prompt. The action is recorded in the operational audit log.

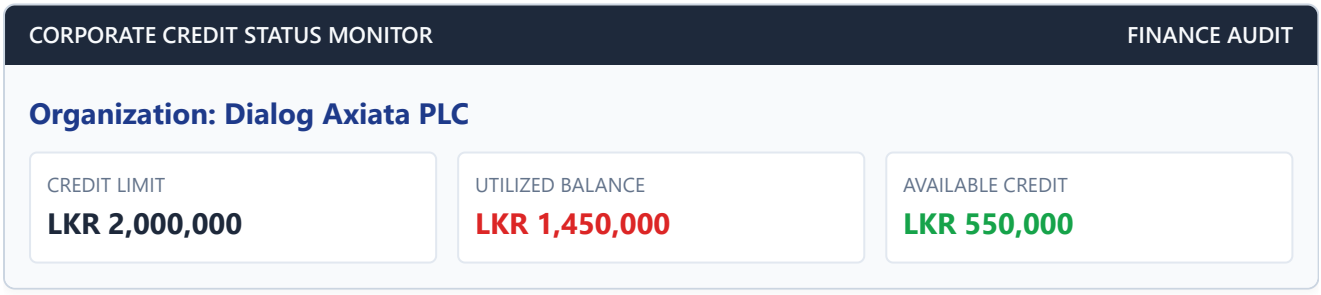
> **Audit Trail Warning**
>
> Deleted reservations are archived from active views and logged with the responsible officer's User ID to maintain accountability.

6. Corporate Credit Management (On-Credit)

Corporate clients and partner organizations are permitted to book Silk Route lounge facilities on approved corporate credit terms. The system provides strict controls to ensure bookings remain within authorized credit ceilings.

6.1 Making an On-Credit booking

1. Select **On-Credit Reservation** or **On-Credit Select Page** from the menu.
2. Choose the authorized corporate company from the dropdown menu (e.g., *SriLankan Airlines*, *Dialog Axiata*, *Embassy of France*).
3. The screen displays real-time corporate balance information:
   - **Credit Limit:** The total approved credit ceiling in LKR.
   - **Utilized Amount:** The cumulative balance of unpaid bookings.
   - **Remaining Credit:** Available spending balance.
   - **Guarantee Expiry Date:** Bank guarantee expiry deadline.
4. If the company status is active and within limit, click **Proceed to Add Details**.
5. Enter passenger and flight information as normal.
6. Upon confirmation, the booking amount is debited to the company's ledger, increasing their utilized balance.



6.2 Credit limits & guarantee expiry validation

The system enforces two strict automated safeguards:

- **Credit Limit Exceeded:** If an impending booking causes the utilized balance to exceed the approved credit ceiling, the system displays an alert with the exceeded figure and blocks final submission.
- **Expired Bank Guarantee:** If the guarantee expiry date has elapsed, the company is flagged under **User Expired On Credit**, and new bookings cannot be issued until Finance updates the guarantee record.

6.3 Recording corporate payments (Finance)

When a corporate organization makes a payment against their outstanding invoices:

1. Sign in with a **Finance User** account.
2. Navigate to **Finance Add Payment**.
3. Select the corporate organization from the list.
4. Enter the payment details:
   - Payment Amount (LKR).
   - Payment Method (Cheque, Bank Wire, Electronic Fund Transfer).
   - Reference / Transaction Number.
   - Payment Date.
5. Click **Post Payment**.
6. The company's outstanding utilized amount decreases immediately, replenishing their available credit limit.

> **Finance Balance Protection**
> Payments cannot exceed the total outstanding balance (the balance cannot be reduced below zero). All payment entries are recorded in the permanent payment audit history.

6.4 Creating credit company accounts (Admin)

Only Administrators can register new corporate credit accounts:

1. Navigate to **Create Credit Company**.
2. Fill in the corporate profile:
   - Organization Name (e.g., *Aviation Services Ltd*).
   - Company Registration / Identification Code.
   - Contact Person Name, Phone, and Official Billing Email.
   - Authorized Credit Limit (LKR).
   - Bank Guarantee Reference & Guarantee Expiry Date.
3. Click **Save Corporate Account**.
4. The company is initialized with a zero balance and becomes available for on-credit bookings.

7. Operational Search & Reports

7.1 Search reservations

The Search module allows fast lookups across historical and upcoming bookings:

1. Navigate to **Search Page** from the menu.
2. Enter search criteria in any field:
   - Booking Reference Number.
   - Passenger Full Name or Surname.
   - Passport Number.
   - Flight Number or Booking Date Range.
3. Click **Search**. The matching results are displayed with options to view full receipts, passenger lists, or print details.

7.2 Flight arrivals & departures report

1. Open **Flight Report**.
2. Select the targeted date and filter by direction (*All*, *Arrivals*, or *Departures*).
3. The generated report details flight schedules, arriving/departing passenger manifests, and lounge readiness statuses.
4. Click **Export to Excel** or **Print PDF** for physical distribution to terminal duty managers.

7.3 Immigration & emigration reports

Airport security and border agencies require periodic manifests of passengers utilizing CIP VIP channels:

1. Open **Immigration / Emigration Report**.
2. Select the report period (Shift, Daily, or Custom Range).
3. The report presents a clean list of Passenger Names, Nationalities, Passport Numbers, Flight Numbers, and Times of clearance.

7.4 Visitor details export

Under **Visitor Details**, receptionists can track accompanying guests, embassy reception delegates, and VIP greeters who accessed the lounge facilities alongside traveling passengers.

8. Sales End & Shift Settlement

At the end of each operational duty shift, the assigned receptionist must close their shift ledger and reconcile collected funds.

8.1 Shift income reconciliation

1. From the navigation menu, select **Sales End**.
2. The system automatically computes revenue generated during the current active shift:
   - Total Number of Bookings processed.
   - Breakdown by Currency (Total LKR, Total USD).
   - Breakdown by Method (Cash collected, Credit Card slips, Corporate On-Credit).
   - Receipt Serial Number Ranges (Starting Serial to Ending Serial).
3. Verify the physical cash and credit card receipts in the drawer against the on-screen totals.

8.2 Closing a sales shift

1. Enter any physical cash differences or supervisor handover remarks in the comments box.
2. Click **Finalize & End Shift**.
3. The shift record is closed in the `shift` table, and summarized into the permanent `sessionincome` ledger.
4. Print the official Shift Settlement Summary report for handover to the duty supervisor and accounts department.

9. User Administration

9.1 Adding and editing system users (Admin)

1. Navigate to **Create / Edit User**.
2. To create a new user:
   - Enter User ID (e.g., `emp104`).
   - Enter Employee Full Name and Email Address.
   - Assign Operational Role: *Administrator*, *Normal (Standard User)*, or *Finance*.
   - Set an initial temporary password.
   - Click **Create User**.
3. To modify existing users:
   - Select the user from the list.
   - Update roles, reset passwords, or set status to *Active* / *Inactive*.
   - Click **Update User**.

10. Troubleshooting and FAQs

10.1 Common on-screen states & solutions

What you see	What it means	Recommended Action
"Cannot find module 'express'"	Backend dependencies have not been installed.	Open terminal in `backend` and execute `npm install`.
"'react-scripts' is not recognized"	Frontend packages have not been installed.	Open terminal in `frontend` and execute `npm install`.
"Database connection error (ECONNREFUSED)"	Backend cannot communicate with MySQL on port 3306.	Ensure MySQL / XAMPP service is running and verify password in `backend/.env`.
"Booking saved but receipt email failed"	SMTP credentials in `backend/.env` are missing or invalid.	Check Gmail App Password in `SMTP_PASS` and ensure internet connectivity.
"Credit limit exceeded" alert	Selected company has reached its allowed credit limit.	Contact Finance to record a payment or request approval for a limit increase.

10.2 Frequently asked questions

Can I book on-credit if a company's bank guarantee has expired?
No. The system automatically restricts reservations for expired guarantees. Finance must update the guarantee renewal date first.

How can I resend a booking confirmation PDF to a passenger?
Search for the booking via **Search Page**, open the reservation details, and click **Resend Receipt Email**.

What should I do if a flight is delayed past midnight?
The reservation remains active under its original flight number and date. If the flight date changes, open **Edit Confirmed** and update the flight date.

Who can delete a confirmed reservation?
Only users with Administrator permissions can delete confirmed reservations. Standard users must submit a cancellation request to duty supervisors.

10.3 Quick Reference Task Index

Task to Perform	Where to go in Navigation
Sign into the application	Login screen (`http://localhost:3000`) → Enter User ID & Password
Log out securely	Top-right header / Sidebar bottom → **Logout**
Check today's arrivals & departures	Sidebar → **Dashboard** → Metric Summary Cards
Make a new Lounge reservation	Sidebar → **Booking Packages** → Select Package & Complete Form
Make a Corporate On-Credit booking	Sidebar → **On-Credit Reservation** → Select Company & Add Details
View all confirmed reservations	Sidebar → **Reservation Confirmed**
Review pending payment bookings	Sidebar → **Pending Payments** → Review & Verify
Edit passenger or flight details	Sidebar → **Edit Confirmed** or **Edit Pending Reservations**
Post a corporate client payment (Finance)	Sidebar → **Finance Add Payment** → Enter Amount & Save
Register a new Corporate Client (Admin)	Sidebar → **Create Credit Company** → Fill Details & Limit
Search any booking by name or passport	Sidebar → **Search Page** → Enter Keyword & Search
Generate flight manifests for duty team	Sidebar → **Flight Report** → Select Date & Export
Generate immigration / security reports	Sidebar → **Immigration / Emigration Report** → Select Range
Close shift and balance daily collections	Sidebar → **Sales End** → Reconcile Totals & End Shift
Add or modify system users (Admin)	Sidebar → **Create / Edit User** → Manage Users